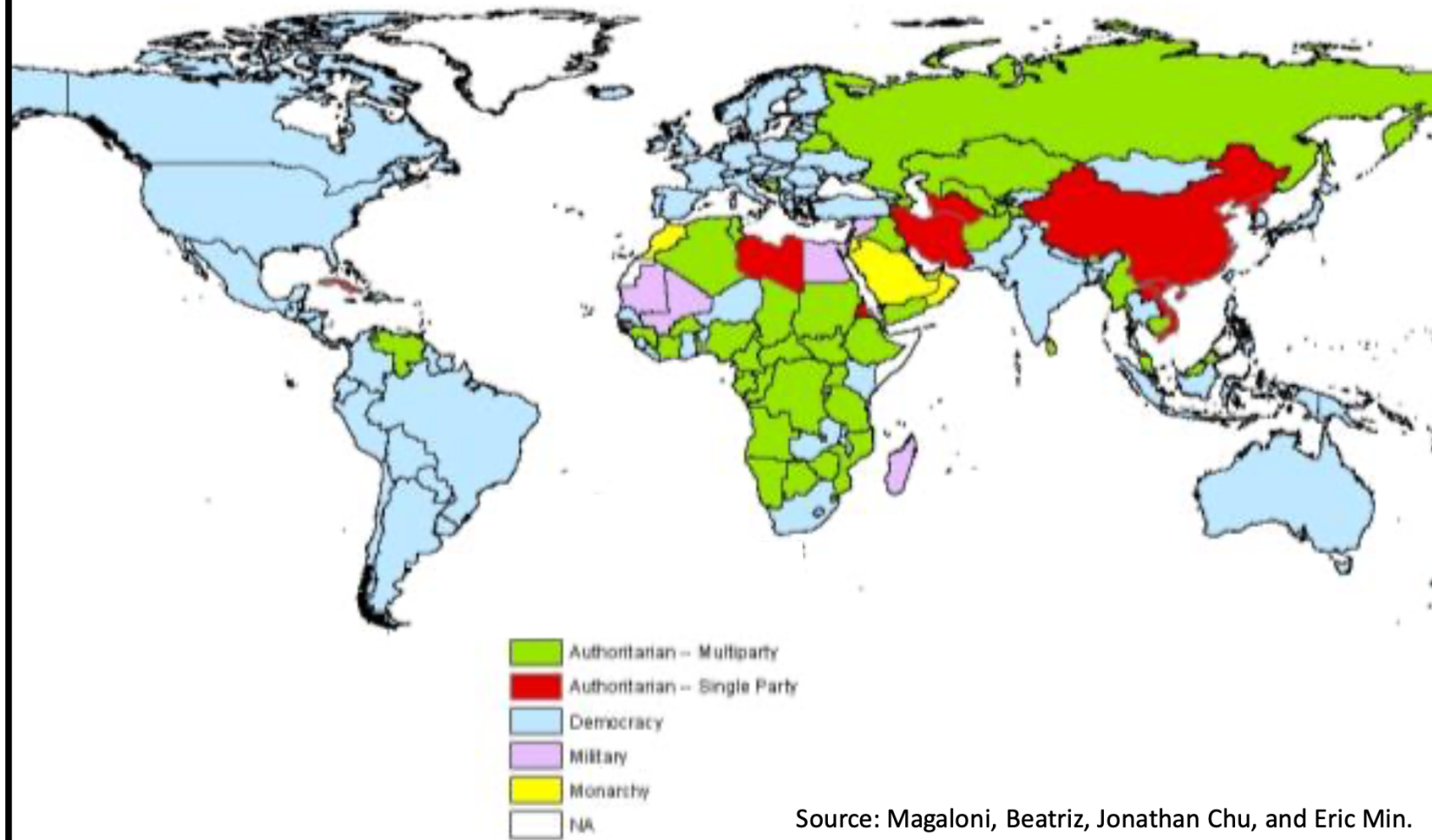
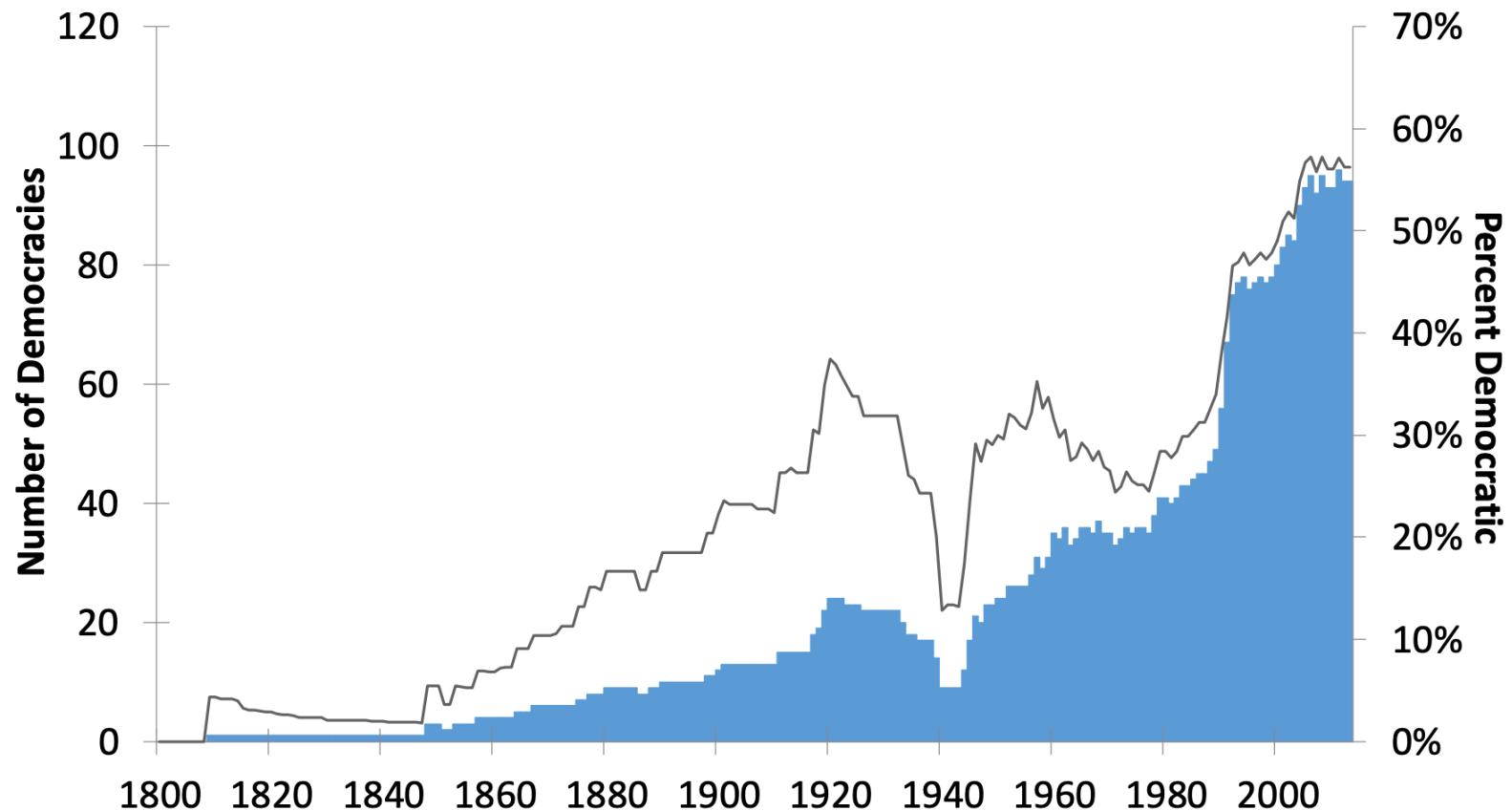


Political Regimes, 2012



Source: Magaloni, Beatriz, Jonathan Chu, and Eric Min.
2013. *Autocracies of the World, 1950-2012*. Dataset.

The Spread of Democracy, 1800-2013



Source: Monty G. Marshall, Keith Jagers, and Ted Robert Gurr, "Polity IV Project: Political Regime Characteristics and Transitions, 1800-2013," <http://www.systemicpeace.org/polity/polity4.htm> (accessed 9/20/15).

Plan for Today

1. What is democracy?
2. How do we decide if a country is democratic?
3. Why are some countries democratic and others not?

**** EXERCISE ****

Coding Democracy: Przeworski

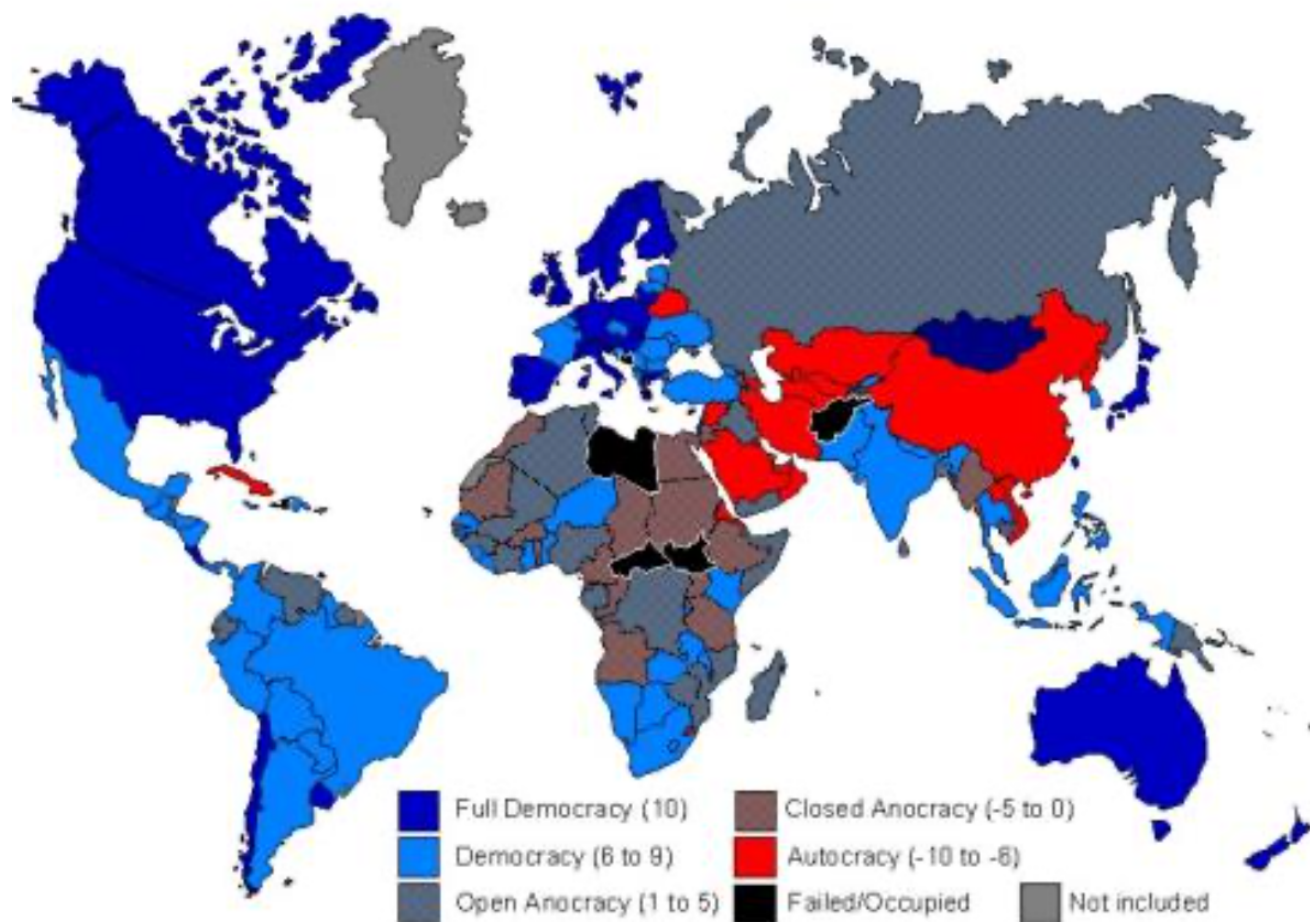
- Regimes coded on
 - Elections for executive and legislature
 - More than one party
 - Turnover
- A regime is democratic if it meets all of these criteria, and dictatorship if not

Coding Democracy: Polity

- Regimes coded on
 - Method of executive selection
 - Competition for political office
 - Constraints on executive power
- Dimensions are combined to create a Polity score
-10 (most autocratic) → +10 (most democratic)
- Countries with Polity score ≥ 6 considered democratic

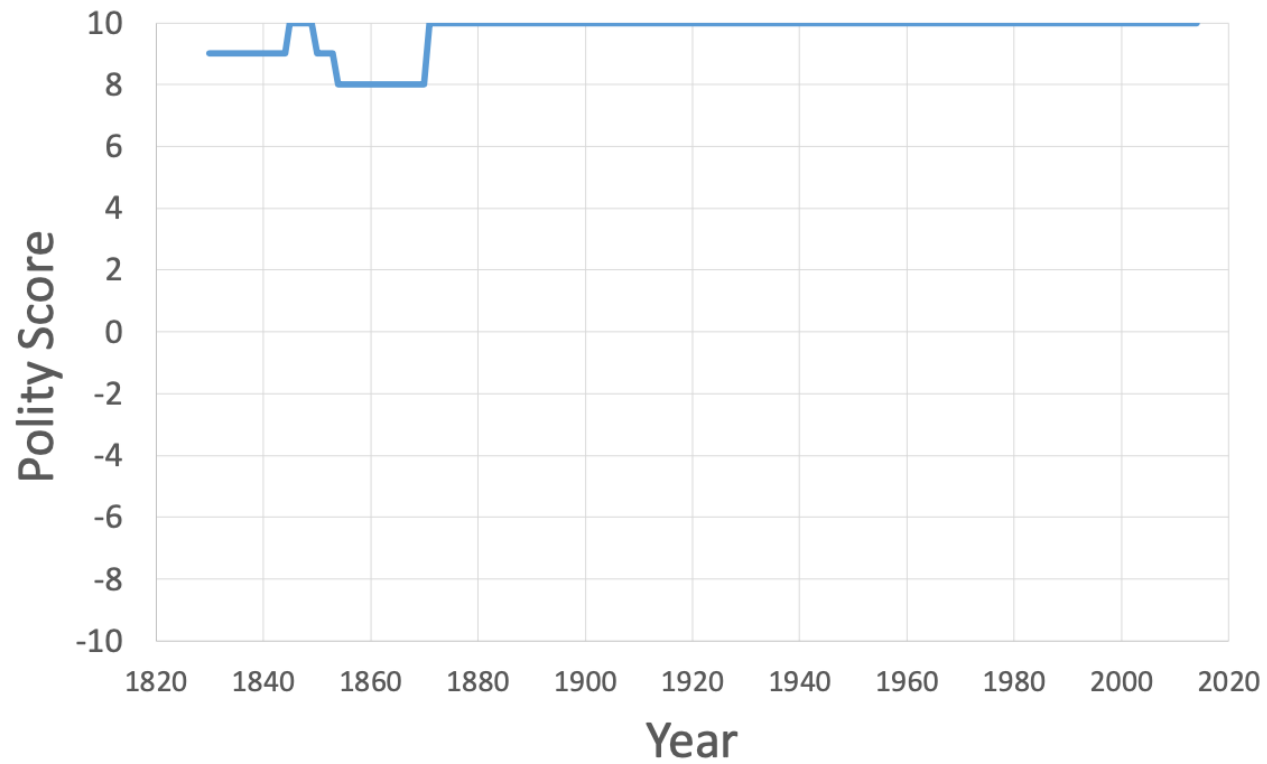
Note: For more details, see <http://www.systemicpeace.org/polity/polity4.htm>

Polity Scores (2013)



Source: <http://www.systemicpeace.org/polity/polity4.htm>

Democracy in America?



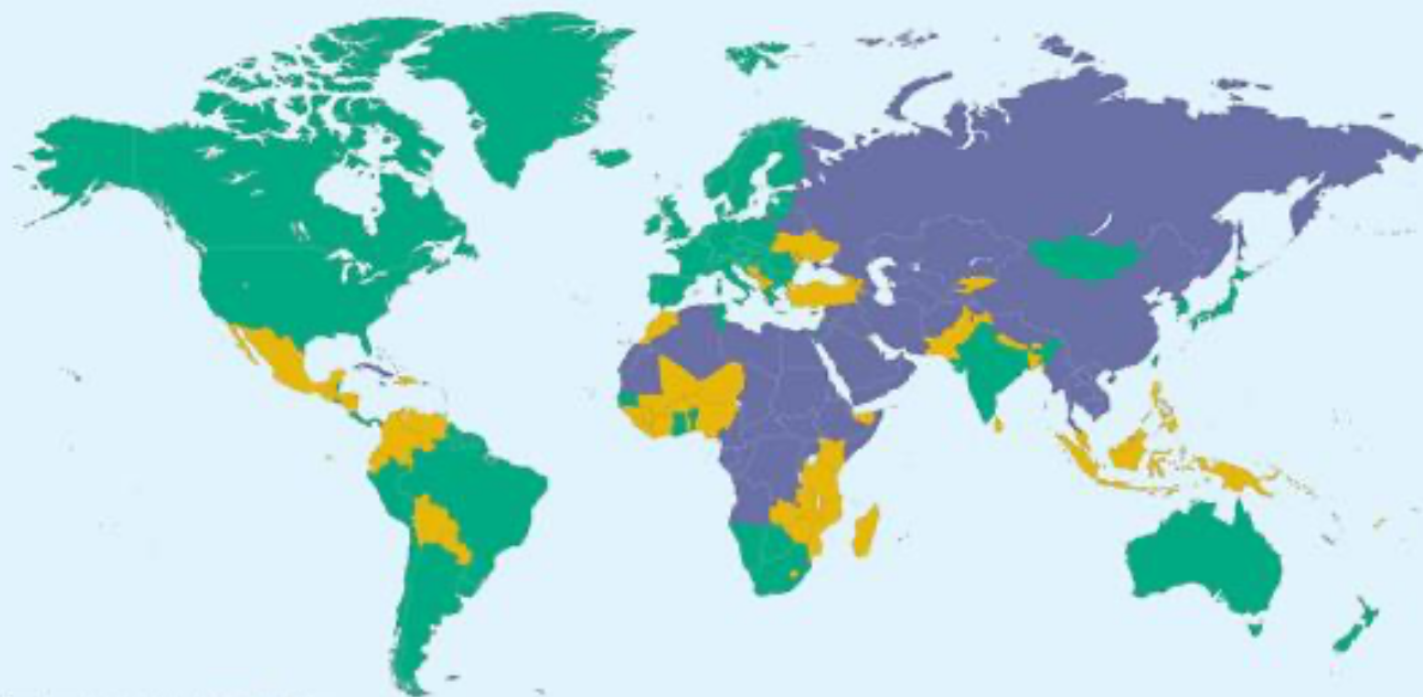
Coding Democracy: Freedom House

- Regimes coded on
 - Political rights (voting, participation, competition)
 - Civil rights (personal freedoms, rule of law, equality)
- Each dimension is score on a scale from 1 (most free) → 7 (least free) 🙄
- Countries classified as “Free,” “Partly Free,” and “Not Free” based on average of two scores.

Note: For full details, see <https://freedomhouse.org/report/freedom-world-2016/methodology>

FREEDOM IN THE WORLD 2016

freedomhouse.org



Freedom in the World 2016 Findings

The Map of Freedom reflects the findings of Freedom in the World 2016, which assesses the level of political rights and civil liberties in 195 countries and territories during 2015. Based on these ratings, each country or territory is designated as **Free**, **Partly Free**, or **Not Free**.

Freedom House is an independent non-governmental organization that supports the expansion of freedom worldwide.

A free country has broad scope for open political competition and a climate of respect for civil liberties. Partly free countries have some restrictions on political rights and civil liberties, or a free press is operating. In a not-free country, basic political rights and civil liberties are denied or systematically violated.

Freedom Status	Country Breakdown	Population Breakdown	
Free	80 (41%)	2,941,140,000 (47%)	Free
Partly Free	55 (28%)	1,798,530,000 (29%)	Partly Free
Not Free	59 (30%)	3,039,210,000 (49%)	Not Free
Total	195	6,278,880,000	



What is Democracy?

1. Multi-party elections
2. Turnover
3. Broad suffrage
4. Constraints on power
5. Free media, speech
6. Personal freedoms

For reflection

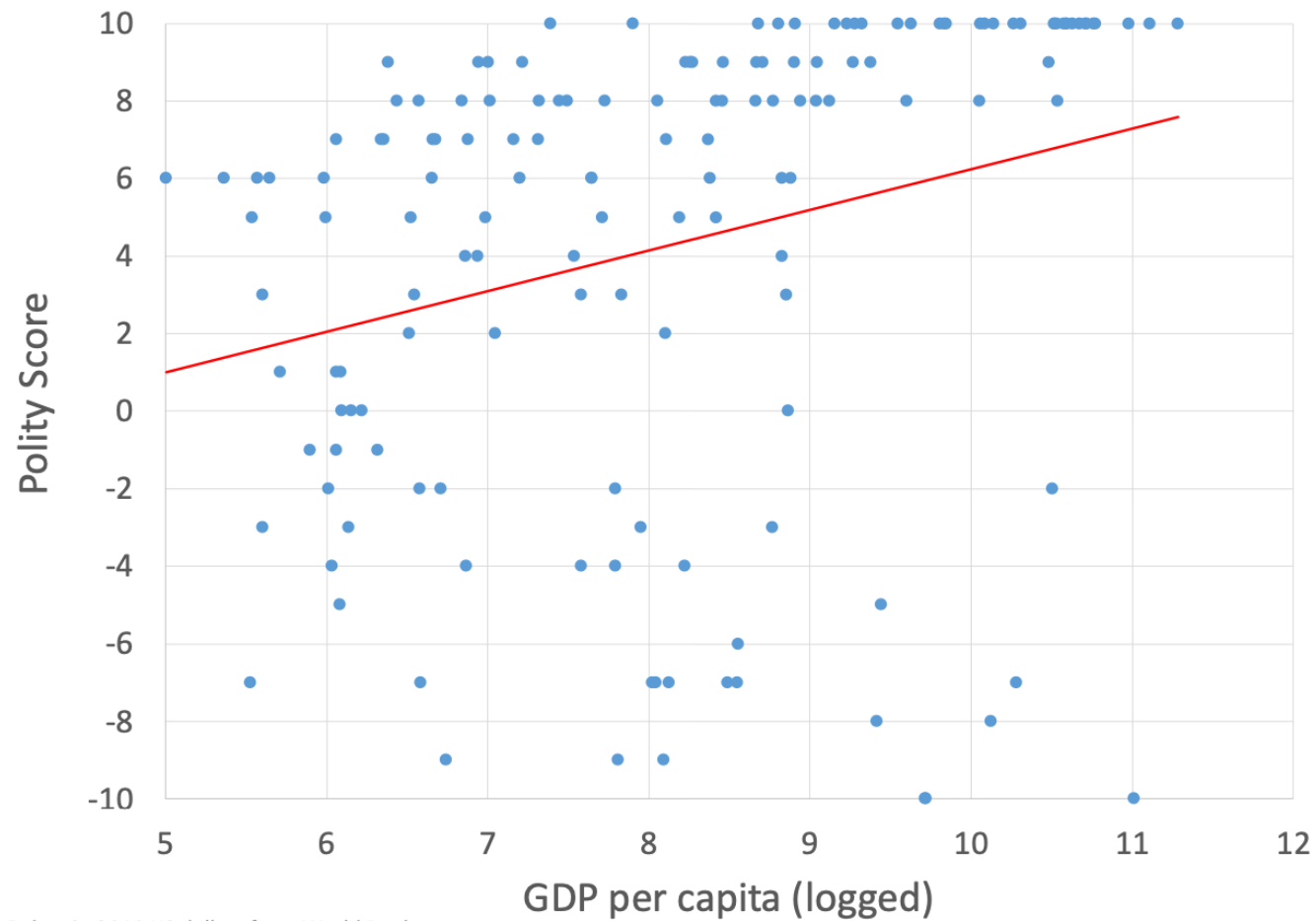
- What do you see as strengths/weaknesses of the leading measures of democracy?
- If you were measuring democracy, what criteria would you use, and why?

What Explains Variation in Regime Type?

- Cross-sectional:
 - Why are some countries democratic and others not?
 - Why do some regions have more democracies than others?
- Cross-temporal:
 - Why do countries transition to democracy sometimes and not at other times?
 - Why is democracy more common in some time periods than others?

** PRZEWORSKI AND LIMONGI **

Wealth and Democracy (2012)



Oil and Democracy (2012)

